needs. So those are the kinds of attributes that we have been able to work on.'

He got the MIT Tata Center to work on producing the technology to make affordable versions of MRI machines. 'We focused on a young guy who was with us to produce 1.5 Tesla MRI machines', at a fraction of the cost of the machines of 'GE or Siemens'. The trust has promoted the company, says a happy Ratan. 'We [sic] [helped] fund its prototype' and the profits from the sales would be ploughed back for its further development he adds with a socio-entrepreneurial gusto in his voice.

In 2016, Voxelgrids Innovations Pvt. Ltd, a health start-up, was picked up as 'an incubatee' of the Tata Trusts' Foundation for Innovation and Social Entrepreneurship (FISE) to manufacture the machine. In the following year, they developed a prototype and deployed it at The Sathya Sai Institute of Higher Medical Sciences, Bengaluru.

In the August of 2023, Voxelgrids made 'India's first indigenously developed, Affordable, lightweight, Ultrafast, High Field (1.5 Tesla), Next Generation Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) Scanner' and it was launched by the 'Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) Science & Technology; MoS PMO, Personnel, Public Grievances, Pensions, Atomic Energy and Space, Dr. Jitendra Singh'.

Speaking on the occasion, the minister said that the indigenous innovation will give the common man 'wider access to otherwise highly priced MRI scans'. With the launch, Ratan's vision and dream (as the launched version is estimated to be nearly 40 per cent cheaper than the imported machines) to bring the enormous benefits of early diagnosis of illness nearer to 92 per cent of India's population (only 8 per cent of India's population live in Tier-1 cities), became a reality.

This initiative of the Trusts was supported by Reif, who was a professor in electrical engineering. He has 'brought new blood to this whole thing, is much keener to support this Indian initiative. He is very supportive of the effort', Ratan says. And working closely with Reif has brought dividends; he is 'one of the most gentlemanly persons I have seen', Ratan adds.

Whether it is eradication of malaria or producing an MRI machine that would cost significantly less than what is sold in the market, Ratan's singular goal is to make a difference in the society by bettering the lives of people. And today, Ratan is spearheading an effort to produce the same kind of magnets that are used in the 3 Tesla machines. Bubbling with